9:10 p.m. the ship was overflown by a fourth plane. A fifth did the same, with searchlights on and off, at 11:34 p.m. The US Navy airplanes did not leave the ship to its own devices until 1:40 a.m. on October 24.[22]

Holubenko would later report on his trip to Cuba directly to Nikita Khrushchev and receive from his hands the highest Soviet award, the golden star of Hero of Socialist Labor. He would also meet and take a photo with the man after whom his ship was named, the astronaut Yurii Gagarin. Holubenko would be remembered for stories in which he allegedly forced an American ship to leave the *Gagarin* alone by ordering water to be shot into the air from a fire hose. According to Holubenko, the Americans assumed that his ship had some kind of secret weapon on board. The Soviets were in the process of developing their own myths of the "eyeball to eyeball" confrontation on the Atlantic.[23]

The two adversaries had indeed met eyeball to eyeball in the Caribbean, and one of them had blinked first. The problem was that they could hardly see each other's eyes, to say nothing of eyeballs. A dark room of deception and mutual suspicion was made even darker by lack of reliable and timely information, and when one side blinked, it took the other side more than a day to realize what had happened. The nuclear age preceded the arrival of the information age by at least a few decades. In October 1962, that gap might very well have led to the return of the Stone Age.